



Shrine figure

This ancestral figure from 'Ain Ghazal, dating from c. 7250 BCE, seems to stare into eternity. It stood on a house platform and was probably dressed in robes or costumes commemorating a revered ancestor.

AFTER

The establishment of villages and farming communities led to population growth and new challenges for those who lived in them.

BIRTH OF THE CITY

Villages expanded into towns and cities **44–45** >>.

HEALTH RISKS

Growing population densities led to **unsanitary conditions**. Living in close proximity to animals allowed **new diseases 52–53** >> to spread from animal to human. Rising populations could also lead to famine and malnutrition.

INTENSIFICATION

Higher populations led to greater intensification of farming methods, such as irrigation.



EGYPTIAN DEPICTION OF IRRIGATION